Shanyu Pankaj Bihani

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EDUCATION

Institution	Degree / Board	Passing Year	Score / CGPA
Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad	B.Tech	2028	0.00
NKSPT's Arts, Commerce, and Science College, Badnapur	Class XII (Maharashtra State Board of Higher and Secondary Education)	2024	91.33%
Golden Jubilee School, Jalna	Class X (Central Board of Secondary Education)	2022	98.60%

SCHOLASTIC ACHIEVEMENTS

Authored and accepted for presentation: the paper *"Materiality of Memory: From Representing Memory as Content to Embedding Memory in Form"* at the 33rd International Conference on Transdisciplinary Engineering (TE 2026), at NCKU, Tainan.

Co-authored and accepted for presentation: the paper *"* Stardom and Self-Referential Cinema: Theorizing the Fifth Wall" at the 6th Mobile Studies Congress 2026, to be held at the Department of Design, Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad.

The workshop '*Designing Belonging in a Shifting World: Co-creating Myth, Memory, and Connection'* has been accepted and will be held at the Mobile Studies Congress 2026.

Awarded the Academic Excellence Award for the year 2026

Student presenter of my research 'Memory, Gender and the Personal Archive' at 'Gender in Academia: Research, Practice, and Safety in the Workplace' organised by the *Public Humanities Centre*, Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad, from 13-18 March 2026.

Art Arcade Presenter of my project 'Confessions' at the Public Humanities Initiative Launch Event held by the Liberal Arts Department at IIT Hyderabad on 26 and 27 March 2025.

POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITY

The Fourth Wall

Head and Founder of Department of Design IIT Hyderabad's official film club (January 2025-ongoing)

Spearheaded the creation of the film club. Involved in designing its visual and conceptual identity. Fostered cross-institutional collaboration with *Goethe-Insitut Kolkata* and *Association of Designers of India*. Hosted talks and screenings by filmmakers such as *Miriam Chandy Menacherry, Swarup Deb, and Subbu Peteti.* Curated the club and the department's first-ever film festival in April 2025. Acted as presiding jury for the special MINA film festival showcase under the 6th Mobile Studies Congress, co-organised by the club and the MINA foundation in 2026.

6th Mobile Studies Congress 2026

Overall Conference Co-ordinator (March 2026-Aug 2026)

Leading a team of conference coordinators in planning, scheduling, and coordination of the entire conference under the jurisdiction of the conference chairs and organising institutions.

TEDxIITHyderabad

- *Content and Curation Head (May 2025-2026)*

Led a team of 12 co-ordinators and sub-coordinators, as we curated the 10th Edition of TEDxIITHyderabad, by far the biggest, and most ambitious in its decade of existence. We brainstormed the theme, created necessary content deliverables, and curated TEDx approved talks of 6 leading professionals across a variety of disciplines like film, AI and Tech, and Civil Service.

- *Content and Curation Co-ordinator (Aug 2024- May 2025)*

Involved in making the theme of the 9th Edition of the TEDxIITHyderabad Chapter. I was also assigned as a coordinator for one of the event speakers and helped with the curation and delivery of her talk.

I played a key role in setting up the XMUN and Masterclass Content, and also chaired MUN committees in the same.

Media Council, IIT Hyderabad

- *Editorial Head (May 2026-Ongoing)*
- *Editorial Co-ordinator (June 2025-May 2026)*
- *Design Co-ordinator (Jul 2024- May 2025)*

ServDes 25

Hospitality Head (July 2025-Oct 2025)

Curated an immersive food experience for delegates from across the world during the ServDes 2025 conference. This included creating branding specific menus, lists, and event flows, along with planning food narratives across three days of the conference to showcase the intangible food culture of Hyderabad.

International Relations Cell, IIT Hyderabad

Design Co-ordinator (Aug 2024- May 2025)

Involved in the design of event brochures, posters, and official event merchandise for international cultural and academic exchange, mainly with Japan, through the institute.

AYAAM '25, Department of Design's Annual Fest

Design and Branding Co-ordinator (Feb 2025-April 2025)

International Conference on Research into Design (ICoRD '25)

Hospitality Co-ordinator (Sep 2024-Jan 2025)

Piano Recital by Martin Helmchen

Designer and Volunteer (Jan 2025)

Part of the team that arranged the recital by the renowned German pianist: involved in designing concert collaterals and serving as a docent on the day of.

PROJECTS

Design Education as Performance *(2025-26)*

A Universal Design-led study in looking at trying to make design education and classroom structures more inclusive for learners of all kinds, carried out through a series of design processes, workshops, and participatory research methods, culminating in a framework and an interpretative performance-act presented to the fraternity at the end of the project.

'Shakuntala' *(Dec 2025- April 2026)*

A practice-based research project examining archival photographs from personal family albums as sites of memory, photographic materiality, and intergenerational memory transfer. Research outcomes were translated into a site-specific installation and exhibition, accompanied by a participatory workshop that extended the inquiry through participants' own family photographs and personal archives.

'everything and an absence' *(Nov 2025)*

A publication-based research project on using print media and materiality in capturing multiple dimensions of individual memory.

Presented at the 33rd ISTE International Conference on Transdisciplinary Engineering (TE2026) and at the 'Gender in Academia: Research, Practice, and Safety in the Workplace' workshop organised by the *Public Humanities Centre*, Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad.

'Nazar ke Paar' *(Nov 2024)*

An ethnographic study of evil eye belief systems, rituals, and associated problems in rural Telangana, which resulted in a game design and communications outcome of trying to use local phenomena in trying to solve bigger systemic problems, in this case, healthcare awareness in the rural scope, mirrored in evil-eye or 'nazar' traditions.

'that doodle thing' *(2023-2025)*

A small business targeted at creating and developing a brand of personalised, hand-painted merchandise, rooted deeply in creating fashion that is unique and deeply resonant of personal likes and reflections.

Freelance Poetry (*2020-2022)*

*W*rote and published poetry on my personal blog and had publication features at Spillwords Press and FlapperPress. Published a collection of poetry as part of an anthology titled 'Afternoon Stars', published by The Alcove Publishers, India. Participant in the Foyle Young Poet's Award run by The Poetry Society, UK.

CERTIFICATIONS

Foundations of User Experience (UX) Design

Google

Jun 2024

Open Design

Duke University

May 2024

The Language of Design: Form and Meaning

California Institute of the Arts

May 2024

Innovation Through Design: Think, Make, Break, Repeat

University of Sydney

Feb 2023

SKILLS

Design Research

Creative Direction

Communication Design

Content and Editorial Writing

Creative Writing

Research Writing

Photography

Brainstorming

Critical Thinking

Public Outreach

Art-Driven Research

Editorial Design

Illustration

INTERESTS

Memory Studies

Decolonial Design Practices

Art-Led Research

Critical Design

Design Pedagogy

Writing

Photographic Techniques

Experience Design

Sensorial Design

Film and Media

Food and food culture

Birdwatching